





Deep in a beautiful and bushy forest,
There lived a happy Butterfly Family.

Mama Butterfly and Papa Butterfly said to Little Butterfly.

"Little Butterfly," said Mama softly,
"a new baby egg is growing!"

Flutter, flutter, flutter!

A baby!
A real, tiny, brand new baby!





Creak. Creak. Creak.

Swish. Swish. Swish.

Little Butterfly waited and waited.

"Hello there. I am your sister. I have been waiting for you."

Everything felt ready.
Everything felt just right.



One quiet night,
Crack. Crack. Crack.

The egg crackled open, and the **tiniest** caterpillar came out.



Early, so early!

"The baby is here," Papa said gently.
"But our little one is very, very small.
And very small caterpillars need a very special place to grow.
Somewhere warmer and safer."

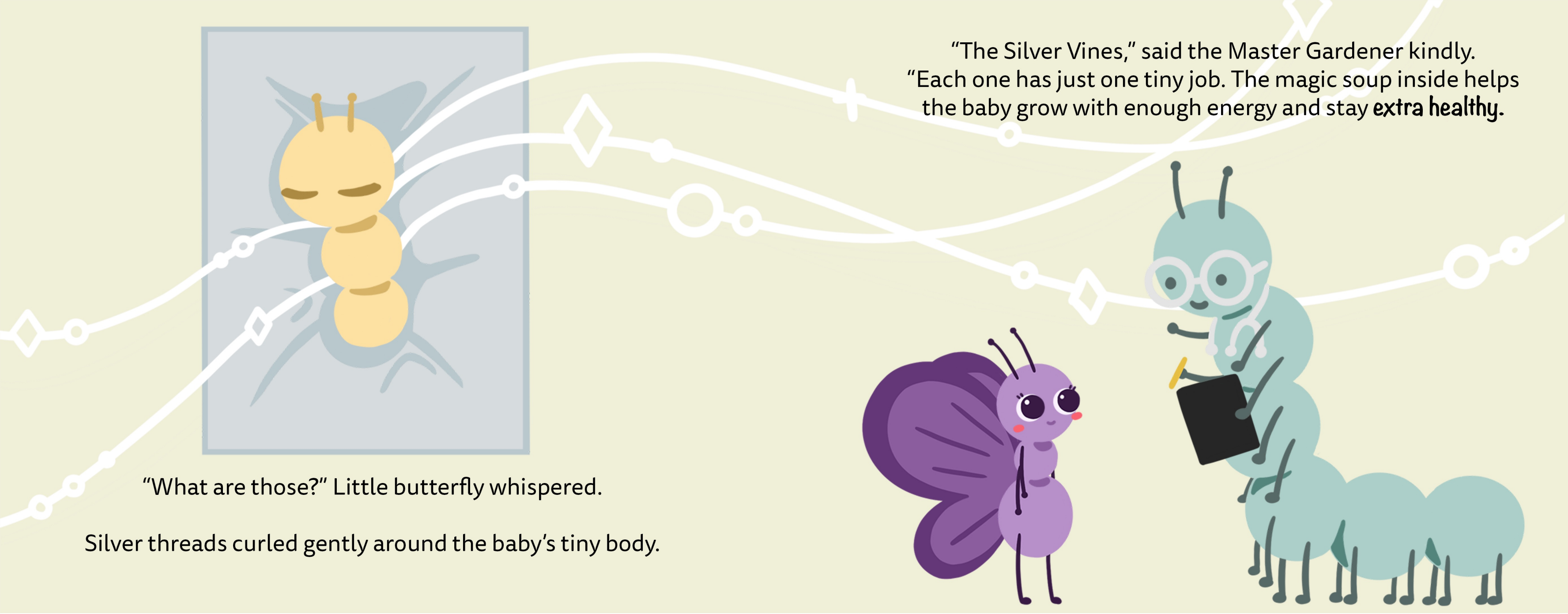


Flutter, flutter, flutter.

The butterfly family
flew to the Grand
Greenhouse

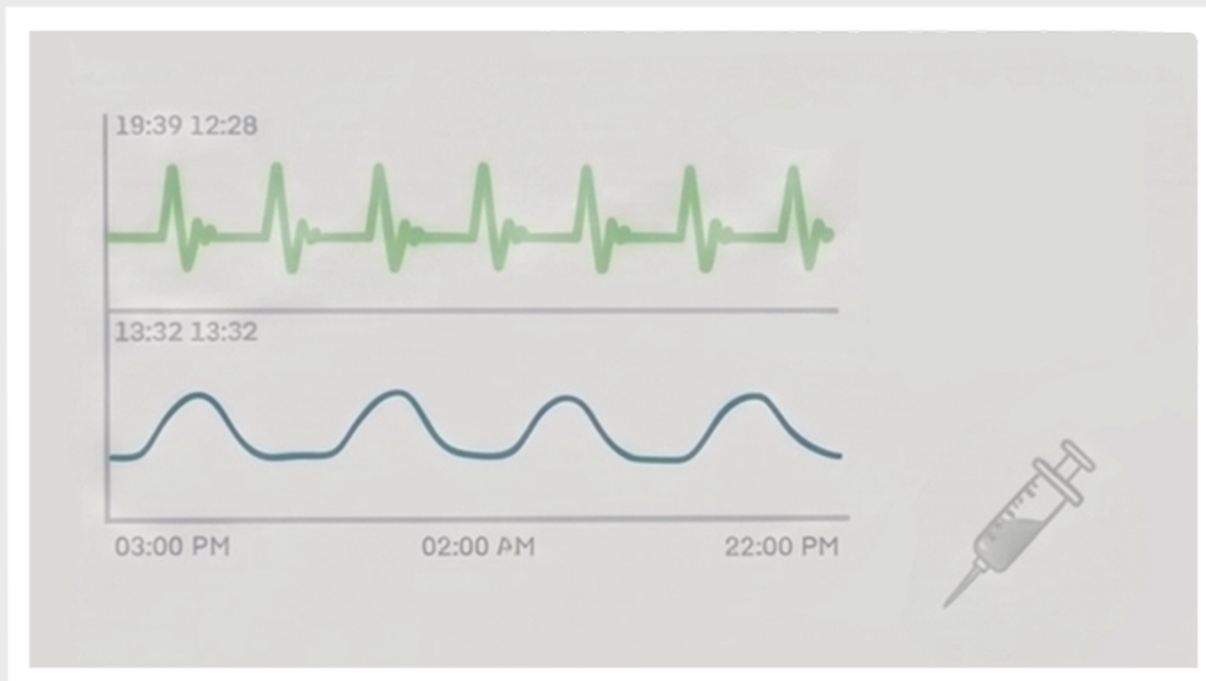
The Master Gardeners work here.
They have helped ten thousand little caterpillars before.
They know just what to do.





“The Silver Vines,” said the Master Gardener kindly.
“Each one has just one tiny job. The magic soup inside helps
the baby grow with enough energy and stay **extra healthy**.”

“What are those?” Little butterfly whispered.
Silver threads curled gently around the baby’s tiny body.



Beep. Beep. Beep.

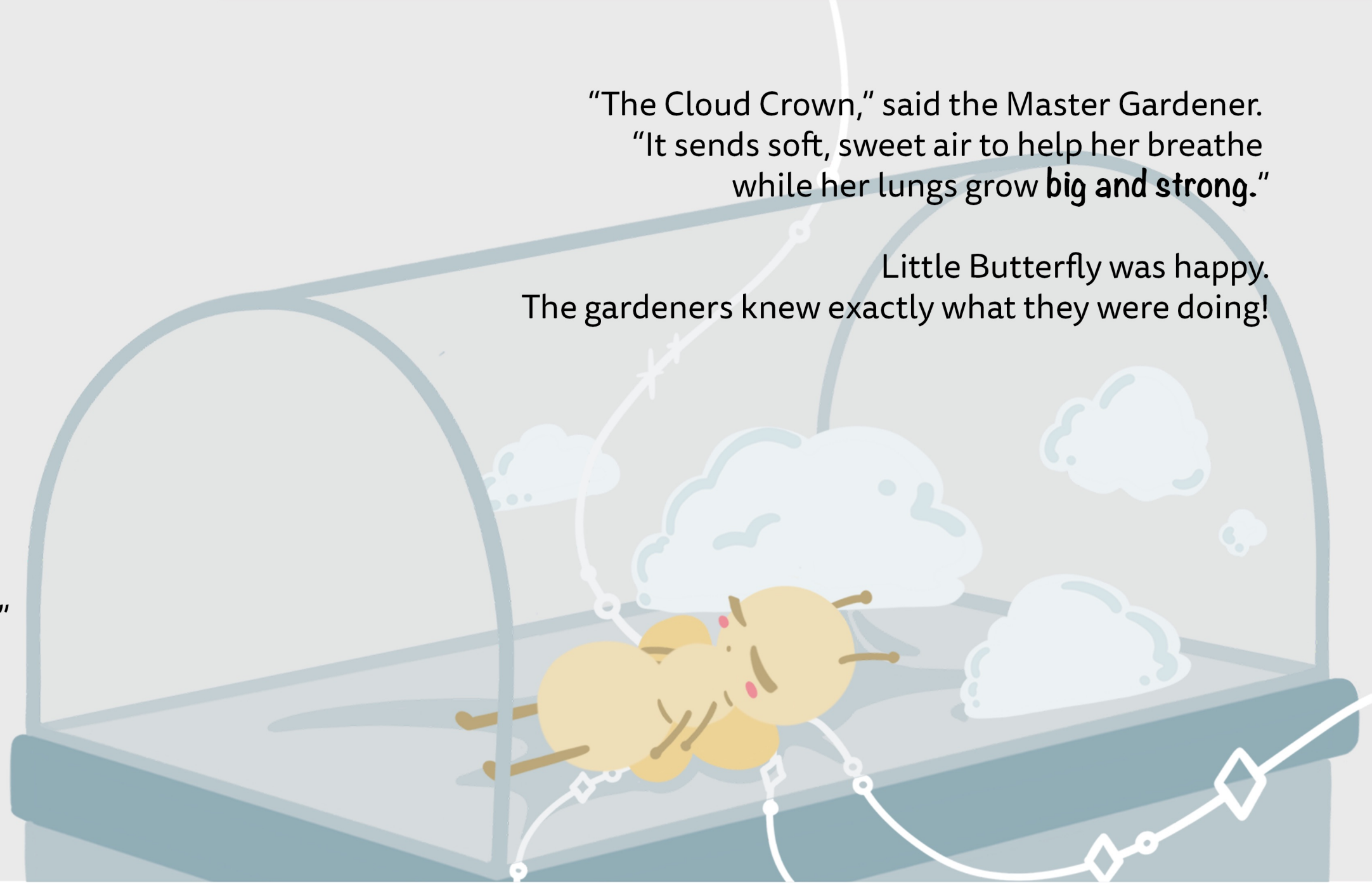
“The Cricket’s Song,” said Mama softly.

“It means the baby’s heart is beating strongly.”



“The Cloud Crown,” said the Master Gardener.
“It sends soft, sweet air to help her breathe
while her lungs grow **big and strong.**”

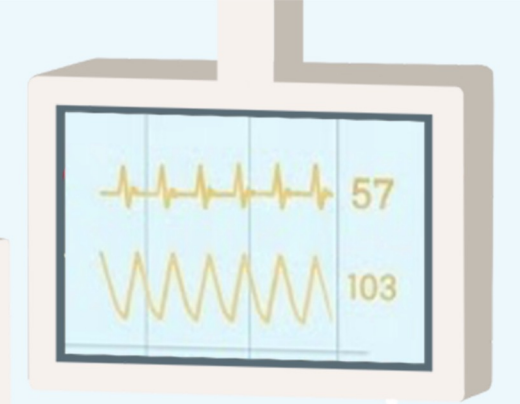
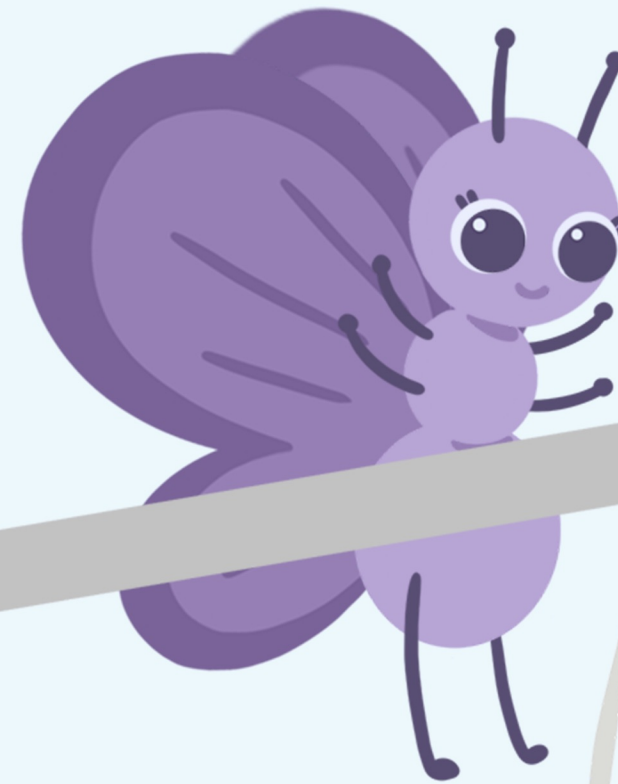
Little Butterfly was happy.
The gardeners knew exactly what they were doing!



Day by day,
the baby grew.

The Silver Vines fell away.
The Cricket's Song got steadier.
The Cloud Crown lifted.

Little Butterfly watched, patient and full of love.



And then, one golden morning, the Cocoon opened!
The family was finally whole!

"Goodbye, Grand Greenhouse! Goodbye, Master Gardeners!!"





For the first time, four pairs of wings rose up together.
They flew over the garden and back towards home.

"You are my Sister Butterfly," Little Butterfly whispered.
"And I will always, always be here. I love you."



Hello, I am Eva, and I call myself an advocate for children's health.

I volunteer at C.S. Mott's Hospital of Michigan Medicine, where I have had the privilege of being a part of the program called Book Babies. Through the program, I connected, heart to heart, with families in the Congenital Heart Condition unit.

Many of the little patients I have met have an older sibling at home. A Brother or sister butterfly who has already grown to love their family deeply, and who now stands at the bedside.

They try to make sense of what they see: the wires, the sounds, the machines.

It was for those children that I wrote this story, I wanted them to understand that the devices attached to their baby siblings are not there to hurt, but rather to help, to hold, and to grow.

And most of all, I wanted them to feel that their love matters, even when they don't know what to do or say.

With love,
Eva

